

Statement by the Honorable Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, Thiru. C. Joseph Vijay, urging the Union Government to cancel the NEET based admissions in medical courses and to permit the respective States to fill up seats based on Class 12 marks.

The National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET-UG 2026) was conducted by the National Testing Agency on 3rd May 2026 across 5,432 centres. In Tamil Nadu alone, the examination was held across 31 cities. 22,05,035 candidates appeared for the examination, including approximately 1.4 lakh candidates from Tamil Nadu.

The National Testing Agency has now cancelled this examination with the approval of the Government of India, following investigations by law enforcement agencies into the alleged leakage of the question paper. The matter has been referred to the Central Bureau of Investigation for a inquiry. This cancellation has shattered the hopes of lakhs of medical aspirants across the country.

This is not the first time NEET has been compromised. In 2024, the question paper was leaked and FIRs were registered across six States and transferred to the CBI. Pursuant to the directions of the Supreme Court, the Union Government constituted a High-Level Committee of Experts under Dr K Radhakrishnan, former Chairman of ISRO, which submitted 95 comprehensive recommendations for reforms. Despite all this, within two years, another paper leak has occurred and the examination has been cancelled. This is conclusive proof of flaws and structural flaws in a national level exam.

The Governments of Tamil Nadu, has been consistently and unanimously opposing NEET since its very inception. The introduction of NEET has severely disadvantaged the students from rural areas, Government schools, Tamil medium backgrounds, and socio-economically disadvantaged families. The Government of Tamil Nadu reiterates the State long pending demand to abolish NEET and permit the States to fill all seats under the State quota in MBBS, BDS, and AYUSH courses on the basis of Class 12 marks.

**C. JOSEPH VIJAY
CHIEF MINISTER OF TAMIL NADU**

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